

- b. Before merging your layers, use the eraser tool to clean up any overspray from painting outside the iris.

1.7. Noise removal

Noise is an effect in pictures which occurs due to poor lighting and dusty atmosphere, causing them to look grainy.

Noise filters are used to remove noise, or pixels with randomly distributed colour levels. This helps to blend a selection into the surrounding pixels. Noise filters can create unusual textures or remove problem areas such as dust and scratches from an image. There are different techniques to remove noise.

1.7.1. Despeckle

Detects the edges in an image (areas where significant colour changes occur) and blurs all the selection except those edges. This blur-ring removes noise while preserving detail.

1.7.2. Dust & Scratches

These reduce noise by changing dissimilar pixels. To achieve a balance between sharpening the image and hiding defects, try various combinations of radius and threshold settings. Or apply the filter on selected areas in the image.

To use the Dust & Scratches filter in Photoshop:

1. Choose Filter > Noise > Dust & Scratches.
2. If necessary, adjust the preview zoom ratio until the area containing noise is visible.
3. Drag the Threshold slider left to 0 to turn off the value, so that all pixels in the selection or image can be examined.

The Threshold determines how different the pixels' values should be before they are eliminated.